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Instructions

for completing the

Estate Planning Information Sheet

The Estate Planning Information Sheet (EPIS) gathers the crucial information we need to complete your documents. I ask that you spend no more than 20 minutes preparing the form to the best of your ability. If you have any questions after 20 minutes, then save the matter for your initial consultation.

Note that the form is a fillable PDF. The most efficient way for me to collect the information is for you to fill it out on your computer, save it, and email it back to me in advance of our initial consultation. If you do not feel comfortable emailing the information, please let me know and I can set up a secure client portal for you to upload the documents.

Client Information: Mostly self-explanatory, but I need to know your a.k.a.'s and *preferred* initials.

Potential Fiduciaries: Often the most difficult question for our clients is, "who will act on my behalf if I'm not able to?" The people you should list in the "Potential Fiduciaries" section of the EPIS are the people in your life you trust the most to handle your most sensitive affairs. The roles for which we will consider these individuals are: Trustee/Executor; Guardian (if you have minor children); Financial Power of Attorney; Medical Power of Attorney, and Burial Power of Attorney. If you are married, my presumption will be that your spouse will be your primary agent for all of these roles, and so you should enter the names for the people who you would appoint to serve in a successor role to your spouse.

Burial Wishes: Your basic decisions to make are cremation vs. burial and scattered ashes vs. interment/burial. Typically, cremation is the least burdensome option for your family, but we see all kinds of requests and your religious preferences will be accommodated first. You do not have to have specific burial wishes, you can leave it in your agent's discretion, but don't be afraid to have a little fun with this section. If you have made any pre-planned burial arrangements (i.e. with a cemetery or funeral home), please supply me with the information.

Estimated Value of Estate: The purpose of this section is more to uncover what sort of property issues you might have versus determining your exact net worth. Please list any unusual assets you might own, like valuable artwork, guns, or collector's items.

Additional documents to send/bring to your initial consultation: Deed to your home (it will be with your closing documents, but *not* the same thing as the "deed of trust"), burial contracts, balance sheet from CPA in lieu of completing Estimated Value section, prior estate planning documents, beneficiary designation forms, credit card.

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ESTATE PLANNING INFORMATION SHEET

CLIENT INFORMATION

Spouse 1's Legal Name:_____

a.k.a:_____ **Preferred Initials:** _____

Address: _____

County: _____ **E-Mail**:_____

Phone: **(Home)**_____ **(Work)**_____ **(Cell)**_____

DOB: _____ **Social Security No.**:_____

Business/Employment:_____

US citizen? ☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If no, what nationality: _____

Spouse 2's Legal Name:_____

a.k.a:_____ **Preferred Initials:** _____

Address: _____

County: _____ **E-Mail**:_____

Phone: **(Home)**_____ **(Work)**_____ **(Cell)**_____

DOB: _____ **Social Security No.**:_____

Business/Employment:_____

US citizen? ☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If no, what nationality: _____

CHILDREN ☐ **None** **DOB:**

_____ _____

_____ _____

_____ _____

Number of Grandchildren: _____ **Range of Ages:** _____

POTENTIAL FIDUCIARIES:

1) Name: _____

RELATIONSHIP TO YOU: _____

Address: _____

Tel; Email: _____

Role: _____

Options: Trustee/Executor, Financial POA, Health Surrogate, Guardian, etc.

2) Name: _____

RELATIONSHIP TO YOU: _____

Address: _____

Tel; Email: _____

Role: _____

3) Name:_____

RELATIONSHIP TO YOU: _____

Address: _____

Tel; Email: _____

Role: _____

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VALUE OF ESTATE

If you have a spreadsheet or accountant's balance sheet with this information, please bring a copy with you to our meeting or forward it to us in an email.

- **REAL ESTATE**: $ (Approximate FMV)
  Please provide the address(s) of all properties listed:

- **RETIREMENT PLANS (IRA, 401k, etc.)**: $
  Please Provide Institution and Type of Account:

- **LIFE INSURANCE:** Please Provide Institution, Type of Insurance (term, whole, or other), Policy Numbers, and Benefit Amount or Cash Value:

- **BANK ACCOUNTS:** $
  Please Provide Institution and Type of Account:

- **PERSONAL PROPERTY**: $
  Please describe (jewelry, unique and valuable art, guns, etc.):

- **BROKERAGE ACCOUNTS AND SECURITIES**:

- **Business Interests**: $
  Name:

VEHICLES: $
(autos, R.V., boat)

TOTAL: $

Do you anticipate any type of real estate transactions taking place in your life in the next 24 months? ○Yes ○ No

Distribution Wishes

Spouse 1

Spouse 2

Describe how you would like your assets to be distributed upon your death, as in "to my spouse first then in equal shares to my children." If you wish to make a charitable bequest, please provide their legal name and tax id number.

- Number of Pets: _____
- Do You Wish to Create a Pet Trust? ☐ Yes ☐ No Desired Endowment:
- Commonly, rather than a pet trust, we will recommend that you select the person to whom you would like to give your pet(s) along with a one-time cash bequest (usu. $5k per pet).
    - Please indicate if you wish to proceed this way ☐Yes ☐ No
- You could also leave it up to your Trustee/Executor to select an appropriate person.
    - Please indicate if this is your preference ☐Yes ☐No
- Pet Bequest Beneficiary:
    - Primary:
    - Alternate:

BURIAL WISHES

SPOUSE 1:

At my death, I wish to be: ☐ **Cremated** ☐ **Buried**

If cremation, I would like my ashes disposed as follows:

_____

If buried, I would like my remains interred as follows:

_____

I have already made arrangements at:

_____

SPOUSE 2:

At my death, I wish to be: ☐ **Cremated** ☐ **Buried**

If cremation, I would like my ashes disposed as follows:

_____

If buried, I would like my remains interred as follows:

_____

I have already made arrangements at:

_____

Professional Advisors Information

Wealth/Financial Planner: _____

Company: _____

Email and phone number: _____

I give Speedwell Law permission to discuss my matters with this advisor ☐

Insurance Agent: _____

Email and phone number: _____

I give Speedwell Law permission to discuss my matters with this advisor ☐

CPA/Tax Preparer: _____

Email and phone number: _____

I give Speedwell Law permission to discuss my matters with this advisor ☐

Mortgage Lender: _____

Company: _____

Email and phone number: _____

I give Speedwell Law permission to discuss my matters with this professional ☐

Other Advisor

Description: _____

Name and Company: _____

Email and phone number: _____

I give Speedwell Law permission to discuss my matters with this advisor ☐

WAIVER OF POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST

We have each read the foregoing material and understand that there are potential conflicts of interest between myself and my spouse in the matters about which we are consulting you. If either of us desire to have separate counsel or desire you not to be involved at all, that spouse shall notify you. We each hereby consent to having you represent both of us in the drafting of our estate planning documents and we each hereby waive any potential or actual conflicts of interest. We understand that since you will be representing both of us on the same matter, as between ourselves and you, there are no confidential communications.

Dated: _____

_____	_____
Spouse 1's Signature	**Spouse 2's Signature**

You may wait to sign this waiver until I send it as part of the representation agreement which I will send for digital signature after the conclusion of our design meeting together. It is shown here for informational purposes.